

Question 37 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

State any two benefits of integrating career planning with potential appraisal.

Introduction

Integration means career paths are based on a serious judgement of potential, and potential labels are followed by real career actions (rotation, training, succession), not by a secret stamp in a file. For 8 marks, explain two benefits fully, then add others.

Detailed points

- 1. First benefit — realistic career paths and less frustration.** Employees are not promised impossible ladders. A strong specialist is not told ‘you will be GM in three years’ if potential appraisal shows limited interest or skill in managing people. Counselling can be truthful. Frustration, later feelings of betrayal, and inner resignation fall. This is a human benefit and a climate benefit.
- 2. Why realism is an HRD benefit.** Notes say career planning should identify match and mismatch between aspirations and opportunities. Potential appraisal supplies evidence for that match. Integration makes the career-planning process honest, which is developmental because the person can plan education and effort that will actually pay.
- 3. Second benefit — better utilisation of talent.** High-potential employees get timely stretch roles, mentoring and training instead of waiting behind seniority only. The organisation uses its future resource while the person is still motivated. Key jobs have prepared people (succession). Development money goes where potential and organisational need meet.
- 4. Example.** Two engineers perform equally well. Potential appraisal shows one has people leadership and conceptual range; the other is a deep designer. Integrated career planning sends the first through project-lead roles and the second through a specialist fellowship. Both stay; both grow; the firm is not forced to ruin a designer by making him a reluctant boss.
- 5. Additional benefit — fewer wrong promotions.** Potential qualifies career moves beyond current performance. Customer and team damage from unfit managers is reduced.
- 6. Additional benefit — motivation and retention.** Visible, fair growth paths keep capable people. Notes list attracting and retaining the right persons and reducing turnover as career-planning aims. Integration makes those aims believable.
- 7. Additional benefit — better counselling quality.** Advice is evidence-based rather than generic ‘work hard and you will rise’. Employees can set achievable goals (an aim of counselling in the notes).
- 8. Exam wrap.** Two headline benefits as long paragraphs, then succession, targeted investment, fewer wrong promotions, retention. Conclusion: both the individual and the organisation gain when career and potential talk to each other.

Conclusion. Two main benefits of integration are (1) realistic career paths that reduce false hope and (2) better, timely utilisation of high-potential talent. Other benefits include succession, fairer promotions, retention and better counselling. Integration turns labels into development.